Olena Kaliuzhna

Product Designer

Kyiv, Ukraine · Remote

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SUMMARY

Product Designer with 4+ years of experience in SaaS, fintech, AI and mobile products for B2B and B2C. Joins teams when a product is complex and still taking shape, and turns it into something people understand and trust: from research and user flows to design systems and developer hand-off. Led a team of 5 designers, designed 3 automotive data products and a Chrome extension rated 5.0. Mentor and founder of a community for women in design.

SKILLS

Product & UX: Product discovery, UX research, user interviews, user flows, personas, information architecture, usability testing, hypothesis validation, iteration

UI & Visual Design: UI design, responsive web, design systems, UI kits, typography, interaction design, accessibility basics

Product Delivery: Wireframing, prototyping, design hand-off, collaboration with developers, documentation

AI & Leadership: Conversational UI, AI assistant flows, design reviews, mentoring, team coordination

Tools: Figma, FigJam, Miro, Adobe Photoshop, Adobe Illustrator, Notion

Domains: SaaS, Fintech, AI, Automotive, Mobile, E-commerce, Culture

EXPERIENCE

Extra Safe is the main full-time role. FitNow, Fruit Fight and TIMEPLACEME were separate projects that ran in parallel with it; freelance work was part-time alongside earlier roles.

Product Designer | Extra Safe | Full-time November 2024 – Present

Privacy-focused messenger with a built-in stablecoin wallet

I joined at the idea stage, built the brand and a component library from scratch, and designed extrasafe.chat, three ecosystem sites and the store screenshots. The team didn't know which parts of the app built trust, so with two other designers I ran 12 usability sessions; the founder accepted all 5 proposals, from optional disappearing messages to a store page about protection, and I rebuilt the website around one clear message. Since 2026 I'm the sole product designer: I turn 31 wallet beta sessions into new send, balance and onboarding flows, some already shipped, as the app grows to 770K+ downloads. I cut design iteration time by 50%+ with an AI-assisted workflow (Claude, Cursor, custom Figma skill).

Product Designer | FitNow | Freelance May 2026 – August 2026

Multi-studio fitness subscription, Kyiv · client project, team of 2 designers

Only 2 of every 100 installs reached a first booking. We ran 16 interviews, ranked 8 hypotheses with ICE and designed 3: onboarding that personalises the home feed, the map as search, and inviting a friend to the same class. We tested them in 20 usability sessions and handed over the flows, a design system and metrics to track toward a 15% target.

UI/UX Designer | Fruit Fight | Project contract January 2026 – September 2026

Mobile card game for iOS & Android · in parallel with Extra Safe

As the only designer, I took a children's card game from the first screen to App Store release in 9 months, with an interface kids understand without reading; playtests confirmed they played without explanations.

Product Designer (Design Lead on Project) | TIMEPLACEME, Inc | Project contract July 2025 – February 2026

AI-powered social gifting marketplace, mobile B2B & B2C · in parallel with Extra Safe

As Design Lead on the project, I coordinated and mentored a team of 5 designers. I set design priorities with the founder before splitting the work, so all five designers moved toward one product direction, and I made regular design reviews the quality gate for consistency and hand-off. I owned the AI assistant chat, its conversation flows, UX logic and interaction patterns, designed to guide people from choosing an experience to sending a gift. I aligned design with tech, marketing and leadership, and the app launched on the App Store and Google Play.

UI/UX Designer | VinAssessment | Contract May 2024 – November 2024

Automotive SaaS, B2B & B2C

Working directly with the CTO, I designed and launched 3 products: VinAssessment, VehiSales and VehiLeaks. Dealers asked for a faster way to check cars and my research across 10 competitors confirmed the gap, so I designed a Chrome extension that shows a car's history right on listing sites; dealers now check a car in three steps instead of copying a VIN into another tab, and the extension holds a 5.0 rating. I built one component library with responsive grids for 1440, 768 and 390 px and reused it across all three products, which let them ship faster and feel like one family.

UI/UX Designer | Freelance | Part-time July 2022 – June 2025

Digital agency, e-commerce, culture · alongside other roles

I designed a new e-commerce interface for Poof.ua on the Horoshop platform, keeping the brand identity within template constraints, and redesigned the Novakivsky Art Gallery website to present the work of painter Oleksa Novakivskyi. At Seventeam (NDA), I ran the full web design process, from site architecture and prototypes to design concepts and layouts for every device.

EDUCATION

Product Design — Projector Institute · May 2026 – September 2026

Product Design Basics — Beetroot Academy · March 2026 – April 2026

UX Design Beginning — Projector Institute · May 2024 – July 2024

UX/UI Designer — Beetroot Academy · June 2023 – December 2023

CERTIFICATES & ACHIEVEMENTS

Winner of the AI hackathon — Shift Education by Projector, February 2026

Google UX Design + 4 courses — Coursera, April 2024 – September 2024

Creative Practice Programs — CASES, March 2023 – Present

MENTORING

Mentor, UI/UX Design — Beetroot Academy, July 2025 – October 2025

Mentor, UI/UX Design — INSCIENCE, June 2025 – July 2025

Tutor, UI/UX Design — Beetroot Academy, September 2024 – March 2025

LANGUAGES

Ukrainian — Native

English — Intermediate